IELTS READING MODULE

Complete Syllabus & Study Guide

1. Module Overview

The IELTS Reading test evaluates your ability to understand written English. It lasts **60 minutes** and contains **40 questions**. There is **no extra time** to transfer answers. Academic and General Training versions differ in text type and difficulty, but both have the same number of questions and scoring system.

2. Key Facts at a Glance

3. Test Structure

Academic Reading

Three long passages taken from authentic academic sources. Texts become progressively more difficult. Topics are of general interest and accessible to non-specialists.

General Training Reading

• **Section 1**: 2–3 short factual texts (everyday life – notices, advertisements, timetables)
• **Section 2**: 2 short work-related texts (job descriptions, contracts, training materials)
• **Section 3**: 1 longer, more complex text (general interest, similar to Academic but slightly easier)

4. Question Types

Common question types across both versions include:

- Multiple Choice
- Identifying Information (True / False / Not Given)
- Identifying Writer's Views / Claims (Yes / No / Not Given)
- Matching Information / Headings / Features / Sentence Endings
- Sentence / Summary / Note / Table / Flow-chart Completion
- Diagram Label Completion
- Short-answer Questions

5. Scoring & Band Conversion

Each correct answer = 1 mark. Raw score out of 40 converts to a band. Academic and General Training use slightly different conversion tables (Academic is generally a little harder, so the same raw score may yield a slightly higher band in GT).

6. Preparation Tips & Strategies

- Skim for main ideas and scan for specific information — do not read every word.
- Manage time strictly: ≈ 20 minutes per passage / section.
- Practise True/False/Not Given and Yes/No/Not Given carefully — they are common traps.
- Underline keywords in questions and locate them (or synonyms) in the text.
- Improve vocabulary, especially academic and topic-specific words.
- Always transfer answers as you go — there is no extra transfer time.
- Read a variety of authentic materials (newspapers, magazines, academic articles).

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